



A RESOURCE GUIDE FOR STUDENTS & FAMILIES

BAY AREA STEM & STEAM PROGRAMS

For students in grades 6–11 across the San Francisco Bay Area

21

Programs Listed

4

Categories

Free &

Stipend Options

Grades

6 through 11

A NOTE FOR STUDENTS & FAMILIES

The Bay Area is home to some of the most exciting STEM and STEAM opportunities in the world — and many of them are completely free. Whether your student is in middle school beginning to explore their interests or in high school building toward a career in science, technology, engineering, arts, or math, this guide is your starting point. Every program listed here serves Bay Area youth. We encourage you to explore, apply, and reach out directly to programs.

COST KEY

FREE

FEE / PAID

PAID STIPEND

Students earn money

VARIES

Check website

★ THE HIDDEN GENIUS PROJECT & LOCAL PROGRAMS

The Hidden Genius Project

FREE

The Hidden Genius Project — Oakland, CA

Young Men of Color, HS

Oakland + Virtual

Year-Round

Technology

Entrepreneurship

Leadership

An intensive technology and entrepreneurship program for Black male youth. Participants build tech skills, develop entrepreneurial mindsets, receive mentorship, and connect with a lifelong network of peers and professionals. Applications open annually — visit the website to learn about the next cohort.

hiddengeniusproject.org

Bay Area STEM Academy — Free Peer-Led Classes

FREE

Bay Area STEM Academy (Nonprofit)

Middle & High School

Bay Area

Year-Round

Multi-STEM

CS

A nonprofit creating free, high-quality STEM classes taught by local high schoolers. A great way to learn from near-peers in a low-pressure environment — and motivated students can eventually become instructors themselves.

bayareastemacademy.org

Oakland Public Library — Teen Jobs & Resources

FREE

Oakland Public Library

All Teens

Oakland

Year-Round

Career / Workforce

OPL's dedicated teen portal for jobs, enrichment, and community programs right here in Oakland. A great local starting point for students and families. Visit your nearest branch for personalized guidance and current listings.

oaklandlibrary.org/teens

YouthWorks — City of Berkeley Employment

PAID STIPEND

City of Berkeley

Ages 14–25

Berkeley

Year-Round

Workforce

A city program connecting young people ages 14–25 to paid work experience and job training, with real income for participants. Some placements are STEM-adjacent. A strong first step toward the workforce — apply as early as possible.

cityofberkeley.info/youthworks

◆ FLAGSHIP & UNIVERSITY RESEARCH PROGRAMS

Berkeley Lab Diverse Pathways (BLDAP)

FREE

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

Grades 10–11

Berkeley

Year-Round

Multi-STEM

Research

Project-based STEM program for 10th and 11th graders. Build real skills alongside working scientists at one of the world's top research facilities. Applications open in early February each year.

k12education.lbl.gov/programs/high-school

SAGE Summer Camp

FREE

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

Ages 14–17

Berkeley

Summer

Multi-STEM

Life Sciences

One-week summer camp for public high school students. Job shadowing, hands-on science projects, and professional development alongside real STEM professionals at a world-class research facility.

k12education.lbl.gov/programs/high-school

iCLEM — Microbiology Summer Intensive

PAID STIPEND

Joint BioEnergy Institute (JBEI) / Berkeley Lab

High School

Emeryville

Summer

Biology

Bioengineering

A paid summer science program in biotechnology, microbiology, and biofuels. Students earn a stipend while gaining real lab experience at a cutting-edge research institute. Applications open in early spring.

k12education.lbl.gov/programs/high-school

COSMOS — CA Summer School for Math & Science

FEE / PAID

University of California System

Grades 8–12

UC Campuses, NorCal

Summer Residential

Math

Science

Engineering

California's premier state-sponsored STEM residential program. Hosted at UC campuses — rigorous coursework, real labs, and a community of STEM-passionate peers from across the state. Financial aid available.

cosmos-ucop.ucdavis.edu

SMASH Academy — Summer Math & Science Honors

FREE

Level Playing Field Institute

Grades 9–12

UC Berkeley

Summer Residential

Math

Science

Technology

A free, rigorous 5-week summer residential STEM program for underrepresented students at UC Berkeley. College-prep coursework in math, science, and technology. One of the most respected free programs in the Bay Area.

levelplayingfield.org/smash

QCaMP — Quantum Computing Camp

FREE

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

High School

Berkeley

Summer

Computer Science

Math / Physics

An introduction to quantum computing and quantum physics — no prior experience required. Curiosity is the only prerequisite. Students explore how quantum phenomena can solve real computing problems.

k12education.lbl.gov/programs/high-school

◆ FLAGSHIP & UNIVERSITY RESEARCH PROGRAMS (continued)

Lawrence Hall of Science — Teen Research Programs

PAID STIPEND

UC Berkeley — Lawrence Hall of Science

Grades 9–12

Berkeley

Summer + Year-Round

Science

Environmental

Teen research programs, internships, and volunteer roles at UC Berkeley's public science center. Hands-on work with real researchers. Summer and year-round options available for Bay Area teens.

lawrencehallofscience.org

Bay Area Teen Science (BATS) — Opportunities Portal

FREE

UC Berkeley-Affiliated

All High School Grades

Bay Area-Wide

Year-Round

Multi-STEM

The most comprehensive Bay Area teen STEM opportunities portal. Free internships, research programs, and workshops posted regularly. Subscribe to the 'Opps For B.A.T.S.' newsletter — don't miss a deadline.

bayareateenscience.org/opportunities

● TECH, CODING & AI PROGRAMS

Girls Who Code — Bay Area Clubs & Camps

FREE

Girls Who Code

Grades 6–12

SF Bay Area

Year-Round + Summer

Computer Science

AI / Tech

Free clubs and summer immersion programs for girls and gender-expansive youth across the Bay Area. Coding skills, tech industry mentors, and a supportive community. Programs hosted at multiple Bay Area sites.

girlswhocode.com/programs

iD Tech Camps — Coding, AI & Robotics

FEE / PAID

iD Tech — Stanford, UC Berkeley & More

Grades 6–12

Palo Alto / Berkeley

Summer

Coding

AI

Robotics

Week-long intensive camps at top Bay Area university campuses. Options include coding, game development, AI, and robotics. Students build a real portfolio project. Financial aid and scholarships available.

idtech.com

Integem AI, Robotics & AR Programs

FEE / PAID

Integem — 12+ Bay Area Locations

Ages 11+

SF, East Bay, South Bay

Summer + Year-Round

AI / AR

Robotics

Design

Hands-on AI, robotics, drones, holographic AR, 3D design, and game design with beginner and advanced tracks. A Tech Leadership Program is available for students 11+ to run hackathons and compete nationally.

camp.integem.com

NASA Ames — Youth Workshops & Internships

VARIES

NASA Ames Research Center

Grades 9–12

Mountain View

Summer + Year-Round

Aerospace

Technology

Physics

Workshops, internships, and projects in space exploration and aerospace engineering at NASA's Bay Area campus. One of the most prestigious STEM programs in California — applications are competitive, start early.

nasa.gov/centers/ames/education

▲ SCIENCE, ENVIRONMENT & ARTS

California Academy of Sciences — Teen Programs

FREE

Cal Academy of Sciences

Grades 8–12

San Francisco

Year-Round

Life Sciences

Environmental

Tech

Internships, workshops, and volunteer programs focused on science and conservation. A great fit for students curious about the natural world who want to work alongside professional scientists in a world-class museum setting.

calacademy.org/teens

Oakland Zoo — Teen Zoocamp Internship

PAID STIPEND

Oakland Zoo / CalTeach Berkeley

High School

Oakland

Summer

Biology

Conservation

A paid summer internship right here in Oakland through CalTeach Berkeley's STEM Beyond Summer program. Work with students in science, conservation, and Ambassador Animal programs at the Oakland Zoo.

calteach.berkeley.edu

UC Berkeley Design + Build Camp

FEE / PAID

UC Berkeley

Grades 10–12

Berkeley

Summer

Design

Engineering

An architecture and design camp for rising 10th–12th graders. Students design and build a functional structure — blending engineering, design thinking, and creative problem-solving on the UC Berkeley campus.

precollege.berkeley.edu

Berkeley Lab STEM Career Talks Series

FREE

Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory

All Grades

Virtual

Year-Round

Career Exploration

Monthly virtual career talks from Berkeley Lab staff, Bay Area professionals, and industry guests. All sessions recorded and available online. No application needed — just show up and explore STEM career paths.

k12education.lbl.gov/programs/high-school

UC Berkeley STAR — Research Opportunity Database

FREE

UC Berkeley

Grades 9–12

Bay Area-Wide

Year-Round

Research

Science

Tech

A searchable database of STEM research and internship opportunities designed specifically for Bay Area students. Updated regularly — use it alongside the BATS portal for the most complete picture of what's available.

star.berkeley.edu

NEXT STEPS: HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

1. START WITH FREE & STIPEND PROGRAMS

Many of the best programs on this list are completely free — including SMASH Academy at UC Berkeley, Berkeley Lab's BLDAP and SAGE camps, and the Bay Area STEM Academy. Programs marked 'Paid Stipend' go further: students actually earn income while gaining real experience. Don't overlook free programs — they are just as prestigious as paid ones, sometimes more so.

2. USE THE BATS PORTAL AS YOUR HOME BASE

Bay Area Teen Science (bayareateenscience.org) is updated constantly with new internships, workshops, and research opportunities for Bay Area teens. Subscribe to their 'Opps For B.A.T.S.' newsletter and follow them on social media so you never miss a deadline. It's the single best ongoing resource for Bay Area youth STEM opportunities.

3. WATCH DEADLINES — MANY FALL IN WINTER & SPRING

Programs like SMASH, iCLEM, and BLDAP have deadlines as early as January through March. Start gathering your materials — transcripts, a short personal statement, and a teacher or counselor contact — before applications open. Being prepared early is the biggest advantage.

4. APPLY EVEN IF YOU'RE NOT SURE YOU'LL GET IN

Many of these programs specifically seek students from underrepresented communities and first-generation college-going families. Your background and perspective are an asset. Apply to multiple programs across different categories — free programs, virtual options, and local Oakland and East Bay opportunities all count.

5. MIDDLE SCHOOLERS: START NOW

You don't need to be in high school to begin exploring. The Bay Area STEM Academy, Berkeley Lab Career Talks, and the BATS portal all have options for younger students. Building curiosity and exploration habits in middle school creates a real advantage when high school program applications open.

6. FOR PARENTS & GUARDIANS

Help your student visit program websites and note deadlines on a shared calendar. Many programs need a parent signature, proof of residency, or income information for financial aid. Encourage your student to reach out directly to program coordinators — most are happy to answer questions and appreciate when students show genuine interest before applying.



THE HIDDEN GENIUS PROJECT

Learn more about our programs at hiddengeniusproject.org